

Kinship Brain — Updated Product Outline

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Relationship-First Operating System for Founders & Operators

1. Core Philosophy & Goal

Kinship Brain is a **relationship-first operating system**, not a traditional CRM.

Its purpose is to replace fragmented tools (CRMs, inboxes, memory, spreadsheets) with a **single, high-context source of truth for people and companies**, without introducing artificial objects like deals or tasks that break context.

Key principles

- The **relationship record is the primary and only core object**
 - Pipelines, campaigns, follow-ups, and projects **attach to relationships**, never replace them
 - AI augments context, never invents it
 - Everything is explainable, logged, and reversible
 - The system behaves like a trusted relationship manager, not a sales tool
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2. Core Object: Relationship Record

2.1 Relationship Definition

A relationship represents a **person or a company**.

It contains:

- Full historical and current context



- Emails
- Meetings (V2)
- Notes
- User input
- AI enrichment (web-sourced)

There are **no separate deal or contact objects**.

2.2 Record Types

- Person
- Company

Record type determines:

- Available fields
 - Required fields
 - Intake questions
 - UI behavior
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3. Relationship Creation & Intake

3.1 Creation Methods

- Manual creation (single or multiple)
 - Bulk import (CSV)
 - Gmail ingestion (two modes)
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A. Automatic Intake Queue

- Emails log automatically
- New contacts appear in a dashboard intake widget
- User must explicitly approve + assign:
 - Pod
 - Record type
 - Initial context
- Records do **not exist** until approved

B. Gmail Chrome Extension (Power User Mode)

- Create or attach relationship directly from Gmail
 - Assign pod + context immediately
 - Bypasses intake queue
 - Prevents duplicate or delayed setup
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3.3 Initial Context Capture

- Voice-to-text preferred
 - Free-form ramble converted into structured context
 - Future versions:
 - Backfill historical emails and meeting notes
 - Help new users bootstrap years of relationships
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4.1 Custom Fields

Users can:

- Create custom fields
- Assign fields by:
 - Record type
 - Pod
- Mark fields as required or optional

Fields are **not static**:

- AI reads fields
 - Fields feed into:
 - Calendar reminders (birthdays, anniversaries)
 - Follow-up logic
 - Suggestions and prompts
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4.2 AI Enrichment

- Fills missing fields via web search
- Never overrides silently
- All changes logged with:
 - Before value
 - After value

- AI-filled fields are visually marked

Future:

- Periodic re-checks for job changes, role shifts, company updates
 - Triggers human review + outreach prompts
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5. Relationship Timeline (Critical)

Each relationship has **one chronological timeline** showing:

- Emails (AI-parsed + summarized)
- Meetings (AI summaries from tools like Granola)
- Manual notes
- Follow-ups (created/completed)
- Pod changes
- Campaign or pipeline involvement
- Field updates
- AI enrichment updates

Each entry includes:

- Source (email, meeting, user, AI, system)
- Timestamp
- Actor

Nothing changes without being visible.

Pods are **behavioral containers**, not folders.

6.1 Pod Capabilities

Each pod can define:

- Required intake fields
 - Follow-up cadence
 - Trigger logic:
 - Time-based
 - Activity-based
 - Manual only
 - Review expectations (e.g. yearly, quarterly)
 - Sub-pods
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6.2 Pod Logic Rules

- Relationships can belong to multiple pods
- One pod must be marked **Primary**
- Follow-up logic always flows from the primary pod
- Records can override pod cadence if needed

Future:

- Conditional pod logic (“if in X pod, override Y pod”)
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- No global task list
- Follow-ups are relationship-level signals
- Managed through pods
- Surface on dashboard as:
 - “Needs attention”
 - “Due soon”
 - “Stale”

AI helps coordinate follow-ups across:

- Pipelines
 - Campaigns
 - Meetings
 - Personal context
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8. Pipelines (Relationship Workflows)

Pipelines represent **workflows involving relationships**, such as:

- Fundraising
- Events
- Outreach
- Partnerships



- Pipeline selector view (active / archived)
- Kanban board
- Cards reference relationships directly
- Pipeline-specific fields allowed
 - Visible in pipeline
 - Visible in record associations
- No duplicate relationship objects

From a pipeline card:

- Open full relationship record
- See all context instantly

From a relationship:

- Click pipeline association → pipeline detail view

9. Email Campaigns

Email campaigns are a **first-class module**, symmetrical to pipelines.

9.1 Campaign Overview

- Campaign cards with:
 - Status
 - Stats
 - Optional link to ClickUp project
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- Recipient relationships
 - Grouped by draft (not by person)
 - Import recipients from:
 - Records
 - Pods
 - Pipelines
 - Remove recipients easily
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9.3 Drafts

Each draft includes:

- Linked relationships
- Template used
- Status (draft, sent, replied, etc.)
- Custom tokens pulling from relationship fields
- Rich personalization (future):
 - Contextual notes
 - Prior conversations
 - Personal details

All campaign activity appears in the relationship timeline.

Each relationship shows:

- Pods
- Pipelines
- Campaigns
- Associated people & companies

Only people and companies create records.
Everything else is a **linked association**.

11. Copilot (MVP Scope)

Copilot is a **read-only synthesis layer**.

11.1 Copilot Capabilities

- Reads:
 - Timeline
 - Fields
 - Emails
 - Meeting notes
- Answers questions like:
 - “Give me a meeting brief for tomorrow”
 - “What should I remember about this person?”

11.2 Copilot Rules

- Uses only existing data



- Signals uncertainty
 - Produces concise bullet summaries
 - Never writes back to records automatically
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12. Dashboard (Primary Operating Surface)

The dashboard is where founders live.

It includes:

- Visual pod navigation
 - Pending follow-ups
 - Relationships needing updates
 - Calendar reminders:
 - Birthdays
 - Gifting
 - Key dates
 - Quick access widgets:
 - Active pipelines
 - Active campaigns
 - Saved reports
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Reporting lives inside the **Relationship Records module**.

13.1 Filters

- Pod / sub-pod
- Record type
- Any field
- Pipeline involvement
- Campaign involvement
- Follow-up status
- Last activity
- Referral tracking

13.2 Actions

- Export
- Share
- Bulk add to:
 - Pods
 - Pipelines
 - Campaigns
- Save reports
- Schedule reports (future)

Future:

14. Integrations (Phase 1)

Required

- ~~Google Workspace~~
 - Gmail - Logs email summaries on the timeline
- ~~Calendar~~
- Granola AI (meeting notes) - Logs email summaries on the timeline
- Web enrichment - Helps with initial data enrichment upon relationship intake

Intake Safeguards

- Approval queue for meeting ingestion
 - User-controlled bulk import
 - Noise prevention by design
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15. Later Versions / Future Vision

AI Evolution

- Agents managing pipelines, campaigns, hygiene
- Smart recommendations based on history
- Context-aware warnings (“They don’t invest in SPVs”)
- Network-based recommendations
- Social graph visualization
- Referral intelligence



Advanced UX

- Relationship summary block (auto-updating)
 - Brain view vs Feed view toggle
 - Maintenance module (drag-and-drop relationship hygiene)
 - Mobile app support
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Ecosystem Integrations

- Deep ClickUp integration
 - RSS/news feeds via Perplexity
 - Financial insights & pipeline forecasting
 - Optional accounting integrations
 - Scheduling + briefing assistance
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If you want, next I can:

- Split this into **MVP vs V2/V3 scopes**
- Turn it into a **Lovable build prompt**
- Convert this into **user stories**
- Or tighten it into a **one-page product narrative** for partners

Kinship Brain — MVP Development Checklist

1. Core Architecture & Philosophy

- ☐ Relationship record is the **only core object**
- ☐ Contacts, companies, and deals are **not separate objects**
- ☐ Pipelines reference relationships (no copying / no new instances)
- ☐ Campaigns reference relationships
- ☐ Follow-ups reference relationships
- ☐ No duplicate or shadow records created anywhere



Notes / Issues

- This is the **single biggest architectural risk**
 - HubSpot mental model must be fully undone
 - Relationships must be the **source of truth everywhere**
 - Pipelines = views/workflows on relationships, not containers
 - Any “copy to pipeline” behavior must be pointer-based, not duplication
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2. Relationship Record Basics

- ☐ Person record type exists
- ☐ Company record type exists
- ☐ Record type controls available fields
- ☐ Record type controls required fields



Notes / Issues

- Confirm there is no third “deal-like” type hidden in the data model
 - Ensure companies and people behave consistently in pipelines
 - Need confirmation that record type logic is enforced, not cosmetic
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Manual & Bulk Creation

- ☐ Create single relationship manually
- ☐ Create multiple relationships at once
- ☐ CSV import supported
- ☐ Required fields enforced on import



Notes / Issues

- Field configuration must be finalized before bulk import
 - No partial or invalid records should be allowed into system
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Gmail Integration — MVP Scope Clarification

- ☐ Gmail Chrome extension is **the MVP ingestion path**
- ☐ Extension matches email address to existing relationship
- ☐ User can create new relationship from Gmail
- ☐ Pod + required fields prompted immediately
- ☐ Relationship created **only once**, no duplicates



Notes / Issues

- Intake queue + auto-ingest is **not required for MVP**
 - MVP = Gmail → relationship creation/logging
 - Fix current issue where Gmail ingestion pulls incorrectly or duplicates
 - Matching logic must be email-first and deterministic
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Logging Relationships From Gmail (Explicit Requirement)

- ☐ User can log a relationship while replying in Gmail
- ☐ Context can be added inline
- ☐ Bypasses dashboard intake widget
- ☐ Relationship immediately usable elsewhere



Notes / Issues



- Prevents backlog + manual cleanup later
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4. Initial Context Capture

- ☐ Initial context included in **relationship intake widget**
- ☐ Context required on creation
- ☐ Context stored on relationship record (not just timeline text)



Notes / Issues

- This is not “notes”; it’s foundational context
 - Needs to feed follow-up logic and copilot summaries
 - Voice-to-text is ideal but not required for MVP
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5. Contextual Intelligence & Awareness (New Section)

- ☐ System tracks interaction patterns per relationship
- ☐ Intelligence layer separate from basic follow-up cadence
- ☐ Supports future “computer awareness” / pattern detection



Notes / Issues

- This will power advanced follow-up logic later
 - For MVP: ensure data model allows this layer to exist
 - Do not hardcode cadence-only logic that blocks intelligence later
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6. Fields & Configuration (MVP-Only Scope)

- ☐ Field configuration UI exists
- ☐ Fields can be assigned by record type
- ☐ Fields can be assigned by pod
- ☐ Required fields enforced consistently



- This is realistically MVP scope and must work perfectly
 - Field setup errors will break everything downstream
 - Dev should confirm where field definitions live (global vs workspace)
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7. Relationship Timeline (Source of Truth)

- ☐ Single timeline per relationship
- ☐ All connections logged here (emails, meetings, campaigns, pipelines)



Notes / Issues

- Timeline is the source of truth, **but risk of clutter**
 - We may need:
 - Filters
 - Sections
 - Or a “signal vs noise” separation
 - Open to dev feedback on best UX pattern here
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8. Pods (Critical Fixes Required)

- ☐ Unlimited sub-pods supported
- ☐ No artificial cap (currently blocked at 3)
- ☐ Pod bubbles UI fixed and scalable
- ☐ Pod assignment works reliably



Notes / Issues

- Current sub-pod limit is a blocker
- Bubble UI needs refinement for large pod systems



Pod Questions → Fields (Important Change)

- ☐ Pod “questions” converted into structured fields
- ☐ Answers stored as fields, not timeline notes
- ☐ Fields reusable for filtering and reporting



Notes / Issues

- Pod questions should not generate noisy timeline entries
 - They are structured data, not events
 - This change is required for reporting to work
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9. Follow-Ups (Dashboard-Led, Not Tasks)

- ☐ No task object exists
- ☐ Follow-ups live in dashboard layers
- ☐ Pod-based cadence drives default behavior
- ☐ Record-level override configurable



Notes / Issues

- Earlier task language should be removed
 - Follow-ups should feel instructional, not assigned
 - Overrides should be explicit and visible
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10. Pipeline-Specific Fields (Technical Open Question)

- ☐ Pipeline-specific fields supported
- ☐ Fields do not create new relationship instances
- ☐ Fields visible only in pipeline context
- ☐ Fields accessible for reporting



Notes / Issues



- Fields must be:
 - Separate from core relationship fields
 - Still queryable
 - Need dev recommendation on best schema approach
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11. Navigation Between Modules

- ☐ Open relationship from pipeline
- ☐ Open pipeline from relationship
- ☐ Open campaign from relationship



Notes / Issues

- Directionally correct, but open to UX suggestions
 - Priority is **zero context loss** when navigating
-

12. Campaign Module (Early Definition, Not Fully Built)

- ☐ Campaigns reference relationships only
- ☐ No new objects created
- ☐ Campaigns can be viewed without full app access



Notes / Issues

- Campaign module still exploratory
 - User should be able to share:
 - View-only snapshot
 - Status overview
 - No Lovable login required for viewers
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- ☐ Email usage types configurable
- ☐ Email types selectable per campaign
- ☐ Drafts tied to usage type
- ☐ Configuration respected throughout send flow



Notes / Issues

- This is critical to how email campaigns work for you
 - Needs careful alignment with your email taxonomy
 - Not just “send emails” — it’s intent-driven
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13. Copilot (MVP Layer)

- ☐ Copilot exists as read-only layer
- ☐ Reads timeline + fields
- ☐ Generates summaries and briefs
- ☐ Does not write back automatically



Notes / Issues

- This is additive and safe for MVP
 - No agent behavior yet
 - Must not hallucinate or mutate data
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14. Dashboard (Primary Control Surface)

- ☐ Pods displayed at top visually
- ☐ Relationships manageable directly from dashboard
- ☐ Follow-ups surfaced clearly
- ☐ Instructions and cues visible



Notes / Issues

- Dashboard = home base



- Pods should be the primary navigation metaphor
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15. Reporting & Records Module

- ☐ Filter by any metric
- ☐ Filter by any field
- ☐ Filter by pod, pipeline, campaign
- ☐ Export results
- ☐ Share results



Notes / Issues

- This must be powerful even in MVP
 - Reporting validates the entire data model
 - If filtering is weak, system trust breaks
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16. Workspace Architecture (NEW)

Team Workspace (Source of Truth)

- ☐ Single team workspace exists
- ☐ All canonical data lives here
- ☐ Relationships owned here
- ☐ Pods, pipelines, campaigns defined here
- ☐ No duplication across workspaces



Notes / Issues

- This prevents fragmentation
 - Must be enforced at architecture level
-

User Workspaces (Personal Views)

- ☐ Users can create personal workspaces
- ☐ Personal workspaces are **views only**



- Personal reminders
- Private notes
- Custom views



Notes / Issues

- Reminders must be user-specific
 - Data must remain shared underneath
 - Similar to ClickUp personal views model
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17. MVP Guardrails (Non-Negotiable)

- ☐ No duplicate records
- ☐ No silent overwrites
- ☐ No partial relationships
- ☐ Everything traceable
- ☐ Everything explainable



Notes / Issues

- If any of these fail, system breaks trust
 - Flag immediately if tradeoffs are required
-

Kinship Brain — V1 vs V2 Scope (Lovable)

Goal

Ship a **usable V1** that supports Kinship's real workflows:

- organizing priority relationships,
- maintaining them over time,
- running pipelines + projects,
- pulling reports and sharing curated lists.

V2 then layers intelligence, automation, and scale.

VERSION 1 (MVP — MUST SHIP)

Definition of Done:

Moj + team can import people, organize them into pods, see context and follow-ups, run pipelines and projects, pull reports, and share lists — without workarounds.

1) Relationship Records (core data model)

- Contact + Company records
- Record detail page shows:
 - pods / subpods
 - linked pipelines + projects
 - timeline (notes, enrichment, stage changes)
- Multiple emails per contact + basic merge support
- List view with filters + bulk actions



2) Pods + Subpods (primary organization)

- Create unlimited pods + subpods
 - Multi-pod assignment (one optional “primary”)
 - Pod-level required questions (enforced on add)
 - Card + list views for pods (visual scan)
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3) Pending Categorization Tray (intake flow)

- Intake via:
 - manual add
 - CSV import
 - basic email parsing
 - Categorization modal:
 - assign pods/subpods
 - complete required questions
 - add notes + referral source
 - Saves directly into records + timeline
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4) Pipelines (foundational Kanban)

- Create pipelines with custom stages
- Opportunity cards linked to relationship records
- Move cards across stages



- Pipelines can be hidden (not deleted)
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5) Projects (foundational module)

- Create projects as containers (events, outreach, initiatives)
 - Each project supports:
 - attached contacts
 - attached opportunities
 - notes / updates
 - Simple project overview (no advanced dashboards yet)
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6) Basic Enrichment (controlled + minimal)

Baseline only — no heavy AI layer

- Email metadata (last interaction + subject preview)
- Enrichment via websearch writes to timeline

Guardrail: enrichment can be **opt-in per contact or pod** (tracked contacts).

7) Reporting (V1 = essential reports)

- At minimum:
 - Pod distribution
 - Pipeline conversion / velocity
 - Engagement / touchpoint activity



- Export CSV (PDF optional if low effort)
 - Save favorite reports
-

8) Nurturing / Maintenance Hub

- Single maintenance feed showing:
 - stale relationships
 - upcoming milestones
 - missing required info
 - Simple actions:
 - add note
 - create follow-up
 - snooze / mark done
-

9) Sharing + Exports

- Export any filtered list (pods, subpods, reports)
 - Generate **read-only share links** for curated lists
 - LP lists
 - referrals
 - city guides / vendors
-



- Granular permissions per pod/project/pipeline
 - AI recommendations (“who to contact this week”)
 - Auto-categorization
 - Social graph visualization
 - Mini-apps ecosystem
 - Advanced data cleaning automation
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VERSION 2 (EXPANSION)

1) Projects — Full Version

- Project dashboards
- Metrics + activity feeds
- Milestones and summaries
- Linked pods + analytics

2) Deeper Enrichment + Integrations

- Broader email/calendar ingestion
- Front / Gmail / other tool integrations
- More automatic detection of new contacts

3) Granular Permissions

- Pod / project / pipeline / record-level permissions
- Selective internal + external sharing



- Relationship health scoring
- Suggested follow-ups
- Project + pipeline recommendations
- Context briefs before meetings

5) Advanced Reporting + Data Quality

- Custom report builder
- Scheduled exports
- Advanced dedupe + cleanup
- Alerts for stale or incomplete data

6) Optional Extensions

- Chrome extension
- Mini-apps that read/write to Kinship Brain
- Social graph / maps visualization